

G&S

A 3-MINUTE SELF-CHECK FOR MUMS

Are you in the **Guilty & Selfish** loop?

For the mum who finally takes time for herself... and comes back more tired than when she left.

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Think Small Start Horribly · mum180.com

10 STATEMENTS · 3 RESULTS

SOUND FAMILIAR?

You take time for yourself. It doesn't work.

You feel guilty before you've even left the house. You spend the whole time feeling selfish. Then you come back more tired than when you left.

That pattern has a name. It's called the **Guilty & Selfish loop**... the G&S loop for short. This self-check shows you how much of your life it's running right now.

How it works

- Read each statement on the next page.
- Rate how true it has been for you **over the last month**.
- Don't overthink it. Your first answer is usually the honest one.
- Nobody sees this but you.

Rating scale

- 0** Rarely or never
- 1** Sometimes
- 2** Often
- 3** Almost always

"You get the guilt going in. You get the selfishness the whole time you are there. And you come back more depleted than when you left."

FROM MODULE 2 · GUILTY & SELFISH

CIRCLE ONE NUMBER FOR EACH

Over the last month...

	RARELY	SOME-TIMES	OFTEN	ALMOST ALWAYS
01 The moment I think about doing something for myself, the guilt shows up... before I've even decided.	0	1	2	3
02 When I do take time for myself, I spend a lot of it thinking I should be home or doing something more useful.	0	1	2	3
03 I come back from "me time" no more rested than when I left. Sometimes worse.	0	1	2	3
04 I usually only take time for myself once I've hit breaking point.	0	1	2	3
05 I eat standing up, drink my coffee cold, or go without things I need, because everyone else comes first.	0	1	2	3
06 Deep down, I feel responsible for how my kids turn out... their choices, their happiness, all of it.	0	1	2	3
07 Spending money on myself feels much harder than spending the same money on my kids.	0	1	2	3
08 A lot of my energy goes into making sure I don't become a certain kind of mum.	0	1	2	3
09 If someone asked who I am outside of being a mum, I'd struggle to answer.	0	1	2	3
10 I keep telling myself I'll sort myself out later... when things settle down.	0	1	2	3

Add up your 10 numbers

Your total will be between 0 and 30. Then circle any statement you rated 2 or 3.

 / 30

FIND YOUR BAND

What your score means

0-10

On the Edge of the Loop

11-20

Caught in the Loop

21-30

Running on Empty

Whatever your band, the statements you rated 2 or 3 matter more than the total. That's where the loop has its grip on you.

0-10

BAND ONE

On the Edge of the Loop

The loop is not running your life. But it's there. Maybe it shows up in one or two places... the guilt when you book something for yourself, or the "I'll sort it out later" that keeps getting pushed back.

The loop doesn't arrive all at once. It builds quietly. Usually when life gets busier, the kids need more, and you become the thing that gets cut first.

So protect what's working. Keep the things you do for yourself. Do them without apologising. And if one of these statements stung more than you expected... pay attention to that.

11-20

BAND TWO

Caught in the Loop

The loop is running. Not every day... but often enough that it's shaping how you feel about yourself. You do take time for yourself. It just doesn't land. You get the time... but not the recovery.

That's not you doing it wrong. It's not a character flaw. It's what happens when you've been running on beliefs about what a "good mum" is that were never true. You didn't choose those beliefs. You were handed them.

Trying harder won't fix this. If effort fixed it, you would have fixed it already. What changes it is understanding the mechanism... and updating the data underneath it.

21-30

BAND THREE

Running on Empty

Let's be honest with each other. The loop is running most of your life right now.

You give until there's nothing left. You only stop when you have no choice. And when you do stop, the guilt and the selfishness take the rest. So you go back emptier than when you left... and it starts again.

This does not mean you're a bad mum. It means you've been doing the most important job of your life on bad data. Beliefs about motherhood that are fundamentally wrong, in a way that guarantees you end up exactly here.

You've probably tried things. They didn't stick. That's because effort doesn't fix a belief problem. You don't need another thing to try harder at. You need to understand what's actually going on... and permission to stop disappearing.

If you're feeling low most days, hopeless, or not safe, please talk to someone today. Your GP is a good start. In Australia you can call **Lifeline on 13 11 14** (24/7) or **Beyond Blue on 1300 22 4636**. That's not weakness. That's putting your own oxygen mask on.

What your score is not

It's not a diagnosis. It's not a grade on your mothering. And it's not who you are. It's a snapshot of a pattern... and patterns can be changed.

WHERE THE LOOP HAS ITS GRIP

Write down the numbers of the statements you rated 2 or 3.

--	--	--	--	--	--	--	--	--	--

Which one hit hardest? What came up when you read it?

NOW YOU HAVE A NAME FOR IT

The loop, step by step

It's not a personality trait. It's a pattern running on bad data... data you were given a long time ago.

- 1 You sacrifice your own wellbeing for your kids.
- 2 You run out of capacity... emotionally, physically, mentally.
- 3 You hit breaking point and take some time for yourself.
- 4 You feel **guilty**.
- 5 You do it anyway, because you have no choice.
- 6 The whole time, you feel **selfish**.
- 7 You go back. The cycle starts again.

**ONE THING TO TRY THIS WEEK**

Next time you get a chance to do something for yourself... notice what happens before you've even decided. The guilt arrives first. Then, while you're there, the voice that says you should be home.

That's not your conscience. That's the loop. Now you have a name for it.

THE PROGRAMME

Naming the loop is the start.

MUM180 is a self-paced, six-module programme for mums who have been last on their own list for too long. It shows you where the G&S loop came from, why effort never breaks it, and what does.

01 The Lie You Were Told

The single piece of bad data running your exhaustion... and why it isn't true.

02 Guilty & Selfish

The G&S loop in full. Why it runs, and what actually breaks it.

03 The Oxygen Mask

Permission to put yourself first. Not selfish. Responsible.

04 The Trap

Towards and away thinking. Why trying not to be a bad mum keeps you focused on one.

05 I Remember You

The mirror exercise, and Michelle... who had been gone for 19 years.

06 What Now

Accept your reality. Change your self-talk. Act accordingly.

[See the programme →](#)

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"The child is not the accountability. The commitment is the accountability."

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